



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Pius X Catholic School  
School Website: <https://www.elpasostpiusx.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

St Pius X Catholic School in El Paso, TX (79905) presents a credible classical orientation anchored in Catholic formation. The school public materials emphasize a classical curriculum that includes Latin and engages virtues and classic literature, signaling alignment with the classical mission. The school also explicitly positions itself as a member of the Classical Latin School Association, underscoring its identified identity within the classical education ecosystem. At the same time, explicit details about traditional classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, Great Books reading lists, or a formal Great Conversation program) are less clearly articulated on the site, suggesting a pathway toward classical pedagogy rather than a fully realized classical program across all grade bands. Overall, the school falls into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong religious/catholic formation and a clear classical curricular orientation, but with room to more fully codify and publicize the full spectrum of classical pedagogy and Great Books components.

Key drivers for the classification:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly foregrounded (Christ-centered environment, sacramental preparation, faith formation, patron saint) and align with classical schools that integrate theology and liturgical life into education. Evidence includes phrases such as “Christ centered,” “sacramental preparation,” and “faith formation is an integral part of our school’s culture” alongside mentions of virtues and Catholic liturgical life.
- Curriculum shows explicit classical orientation (classical curriculum, Latin, and classic literature) and a stated intention to participate in classical networks, which supports a classical posture.
- Pedagogy evidence is more aspirational than explicit on the site. There are clear signals of classical aims (Latin, classical literature) but fewer public, detailed statements about Socratic seminars, Great Books, or the Great Conversation. Additional pedagogy signals appear in knowledge-base materials that discuss scholé, singing/chanting, memory, and contemplative elements, which can align with classical pedagogy but are not always stated in SPX site text.
- Faculty signals emphasize the role of teachers as mentors and the seriousness of staff, with language about highly qualified teachers and a partnership with parents, but without a fully elaborated “living curriculum” portrait.
- Parents & Community signals strongly emphasize partnership with parents, parental formation, and open campus visits, aligning well with classical education’s emphasis on parent involvement and formation.

#### Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note on keyword method: For each category, I list keywords/phrases found in public materials, map them to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements lexicon, and assess the proportion of positive vs. negative indicators seen. This forms the basis for the category rating.

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### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a Catholic, Christ-centered environment with sacramental preparation and faith formation as central components. Principal’s message explicitly emphasizes a Christ-centered, faith-filled atmosphere and sacramental preparation, aligning with a theological and liturgical foundation.

- The message also references Catholic patronage and Marian devotion (Blessed Mother and St. Pius X), signaling liturgical and communal life in education.
- The use of Latin within a classical curriculum, imbued with virtues and classic literature, signals a coherence between religious formation and a transcendent frame (virtue, truth, beauty), characteristic of classical schools that ground education in transcendentals.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): Christ-centered, sacramental, faith formation, virtues, classic literature, Latin, Catholic patronage, liturgical life (implied by sacramental focus). - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials (e.g., no signals of secularism, relativism, or values clarification in the available text).

Why this rating - The materials show a robust theological/ liturgical orientation with explicit Catholic formation, which aligns with the positive signals in the lexicon for theological grounding, liturgy, and sacred life. The absence of negative signals strengthens the assessment. This category meets the core criterion of transcendental moral realism and grounded theology.

Citations: Principal's Message and Catholic framing in SPX site text.

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## Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Formation and virtue are foregrounded; the school highlights faith formation, virtue, and classical curriculum as core aims, signaling formation over mere information. - The school presents a classical curriculum (with Latin) as part of its mission, implying an aim toward wisdom and human flourishing consistent with the true/good/beautiful telos. - The school's Catholic identity, and the emphasis on parental partnership, aligns with the classical mission to form a virtuous, intellectually engaged person rather than "workforce-ready" training alone.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): formation, virtue, wisdom (implied by virtuous formation and classical aims), true/good/beautiful (implied via "classic literature" and classical mission), liberal education (implied by classical approach), scholé (formation/rest/well-ordered life) (implied by the overall classical framing in the broader knowledge-base documents). - Negative keywords: none evident in public SPX materials (no explicit job-prep or workforce-tilted language is visible in the captured texts).

Why this rating - The emphasis on formation, virtue, and a classical, morally grounded education aligns well with the classical taxonomy for purpose and telos. The Catholic framing supports the transcendental dimension. Some explicit indicators (e.g., direct references to "true/beautiful/good" in the school's own statements are implicit rather than literal, but the alignment is strong.

Citations: Principal's Message; curriculum signals; "classical curriculum" language.

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## Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Principal's Message explicitly states the curriculum is classical and includes Latin, imbued with virtue and classic literature. This is a central marker of a classical curriculum. - The school is a Proud Partner Member of the Classical Latin School Association, signaling commitment to classical education standards and the Latin component. - The site references a curriculum that emphasizes classical methods and content in a Catholic setting, with public materials noting Latin inclusion as part of the classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): classical curriculum, Latin, classic literature, classical Latin School Association, liberal arts orientation (implied by classical framing). - Negative keywords present: None detected in the public materials regarding curriculum where the classical approach is concerned (no "social studies-first" or "project-based-first" language is visible in the captured text).

Why this rating - The core curriculum signals strongly align with classical education: Latin, classical literature, and an explicit classical curriculum; affiliation with a classical Latin education network supports the alignment. The absence of explicit contradictions strengthens the Classical status in this category.

Citations: Principal's Message; Classical Latin School Association mention; Curriculum page reference.

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**Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a classical curriculum and formation, but explicit statement of key classical pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, strict Great Books engagement, graded “grammar–logic–rhetoric” progression, or full Great Conversation program) is not clearly articulated on the SPX site. The publicly visible pedagogy references center on a general classical flavor (Latin, literature) rather than a full enumeration of pedagogy in the classical sense. - Knowledge-base pedagogical literature in the prompt (The Good Teacher and The Scholastic Way) discusses singing/chanting, wonder, scholé, memory work, and contemplative pedagogy as classical teaching tools (these come from the general classical education lexicon, not SPX’s site). This provides a framework for what a classical pedagogy can look like, but SPX’s public site does not always explicitly claim those methods. - There are hints of memory-work and ritualized, contemplative aspects (e.g., liturgical life and memory-based routines) in the broader classical lexicon and associated materials, which SPX partially embodies through its faith formation and liturgical life. However, explicit statements about the full spectrum of pedagogical methods (e.g., detailed use of memory work, chanting, recitation in the classroom, or upper-school Socratic seminars) are not clearly documented on the site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): scholé, wonder, chanting, memory work, seminar, rhetoric, dialogue, contemplative learning (these are described in the knowledge-base pedagogical texts and can map to classical pedagogy; SPX site contains elements like Latin, classical literature, and a community culture that can support such methods, though not always described in pedagogical terms). - Negative keywords present: a lack of explicit affirmations for Socratic seminars, explicit Great Books reading lists, or a structured “grammar–logic–rhetoric” progression in SPX public text. The absence of these explicit pedagogical statements yields some gaps from the classical pedagogical standard.

Why this rating - SPX demonstrates a classical curricular emphasis and religious formation but does not consistently articulate a complete classical pedagogy in public-facing materials. The presence of memory/ritual practices and liturgical life could support a contemplative pedagogy, but the absence of explicit Socratic/seminar-based or grammar–logic–rhetoric pedagogy in public materials lowers the rating from Classical to Somewhat Classical.

Citations: Principal’s Message; related classical pedagogy sources in the knowledge base.

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**Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The site describes teachers as highly qualified and dedicated to Christian education and student safety, indicating strong teacher quality and moral formation. This aligns with the notion of model teachers and mentors in classical education. - The public materials emphasize a partnership between parents and teachers and a clearly respectful school climate, which supports a collegial atmosphere, yet the explicit “living curriculum” portrait of faculty or a “portrait of a teacher” is not strongly advertised on the site itself. The classical lexicon’s ideal of faculty as living curriculum and moral exemplars exists as aspirational guidance in the knowledge base rather than as explicit SPX messaging. - The school’s messaging foregrounds Catholic formation and virtue in teachers, which aligns with the classical school expectation that faculty model virtue and knowledge.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): model teachers, mentors, virtuous teachers, living curriculum (not explicitly stated on SPX site, but the messaging around staff quality and faith formation aligns with the spirit of these terms), collegial culture. - Negative keywords present: None clearly present in SPX’s public materials (no explicit claims of non-classical approaches or teacher burnout of the classical identity).

Why this rating - While the site asserts strong teacher quality and faith formation, it does not consistently publish the fuller classical faculty portrait or the explicit “living curriculum” concept. Thus, it sits in SOMEWHAT

CLASSICAL due to solid teacher quality + conservative alignment but without the explicit classical-faculty archetype being clearly proclaimed.

Citations: Principal's Message; staff/teacher language.

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### Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes partnership with parents and asserts that parents are primary educators, which is a strong sign of the classical education model's emphasis on family formation and shared mission. The principal notes a partnership with parents and their central role in education. - The school provides Parent Resources and information about programs (TEFA/ESA and formation opportunities), indicating an active effort to educate and involve parents beyond classroom time. - There are explicit cues about parent involvement, parental book studies, seminars, and family life integration, with mentions of parent formation and book clubs in the knowledge-base lexicon as ideal signals for classical school community life (and the SPX site content implies analogous activities through its family-oriented messaging and events). - The site also shows an open campus approach with ways for parents to visit and engage, consistent with classical education's communal focus.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (mapped): partnership with parents, parents as co-teachers, parent formation, open campus, family liturgy alignment, parent seminars/book clubs, community events. - Negative keywords present: none detected in SPX's public materials.

Why this rating - The SPX site strongly emphasizes parental partnership, formation of parents, and an inviting community, which matches the classical model's expectations for active parent involvement and community integration.

Citations: Principal's Message; Parent Resources; event-related materials.

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### What Would Move the Needle

- Make the classical pedagogy explicit: Publish a dedicated section detailing the full pedagogy (grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, Socratic seminars for upper grades, and explicit Great Books/-Great Conversation components). This would elevate Element 4 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
  - Publicly affirm Great Books/Great Conversation: List a current Great Books reading list or annual selection across grade bands, and provide evidence of how Great Books integrate with history, literature, and theology. The addition would strengthen Element 3 and Element 4.
  - Expand teacher portraits and faculty development: Add a formal “Living Curriculum” portrait of the teacher, and describe ongoing classical pedagogy training for faculty to meet the classical standard in Element 5.
  - Formalize historical integration across disciplines: Demonstrate how history is woven into multiple disciplines beyond social studies, emphasizing Western civilization, primary sources, and timeline-based learning across grades (to reinforce Element 3).
  - Increase explicit articulation of the “true/good/beautiful” telos in communications: Include direct statements about truth, goodness, and beauty in mission statements and curriculum descriptions (to strengthen Element 2).
  - Deepen parent formation offerings: Expand book studies, seminar series, and home-based liturgy alignment with more frequent opportunities for parents to be co-teachers (to reinforce Element 6 and the general Classical formation approach).
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## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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